RAS TAFARI INC. · FULL SPECTRUM AT RAINBOW BEACH

2027 Proposed Calendar

Rainbow Beach Park, 3111 E. 77th St., Chicago. Every part is free. The dates below are proposed: each one is confirmed with park staff before it is announced, and stage shows and festival days each get their own Special Event Permit.

★ February 2027: Black History Month & Valentine's

DATE	EVENT
Sat, Feb 6, 1–3 pm	**Remix the Record, session 1: Find your story.** Black History Month research with AI, led by Albert Harris. Pick one specific person, place and moment.
Sat, Feb 13, 1–3 pm	**Session 2: Check it, then write it.** The two-source rule; two songs per topic, "The Story" and "The Echo."
Sat, Feb 13, evening	**Lovers Rock Valentine's Party.** Lovers rock and Chicago soul love songs for couples, families and elders; kids make valentines for seniors.
Sat, Feb 20, 1–3 pm	**Session 3: Make the tracks.** Songs become tracks; DJ students set the running order.
Sat, Feb 27, 5–8 pm	**The Journey Set.** DJs mix every team's songs into one set that travels through Black history in order.

All ages. Children under 13 work in a family team with a grown-up at the keyboard.

★ January, March, April & May 2027: Winter and spring

DATE	EVENT
Sat, Jan 9, 1–3 pm	**DJ Lab Open House.** Try the decks, meet the teachers and sign up for the winter–spring cohort. Starter controllers on hand for anyone without equipment.
Week of Jan 11	**Winter–spring DJ cohort begins.** 14 weekly 90-minute sessions for Little DJs, Junior, Teen, Empress Decks and Grown-Up & Elder DJs.
Mon, Jan 18	**Martin Luther King Jr. Day of Service: Dream Decks.** A morning service project with neighbors, then a family set of freedom songs and Dr. King's words.
March, all month	**Women's History Month: Empress Decks.** Women DJs lead every class in March.
Sat, Mar 27, 5–8 pm	**Empress Decks Showcase.** Girls from the cohort play alongside women DJs from Chicago's house, reggae and hip-hop scenes.
Apr 1 – Apr 30	**Open call for Rainbow Wednesdays.** Youth DJs and young instrumentalists (ages 12–24) send a short mix or phone video. Shared through the park, schools, churches, libraries and social media.
Sat, Apr 10, 17 & 24, 1–3 pm	**Spring workshops 1–3** (free): beatmatching and blending; building a set; live looping and editing.
Sat, Apr 24, 10 am–noon	**Earth Day Beach Cleanup.** Neighbors and families clean Rainbow Beach to a youth DJ set.
Sat, May 1, 5–7 pm	**Cohort Graduation Set.** Winter–spring graduates play for their families; Passport certificates handed out.
Sat, May 1 & 8, 1–3 pm	**Spring workshops 4–5**: playing with live instruments; the Theme Clash (wordplay and genre-mixing).
Sat, May 15, 11 am–3 pm	**Heroes Day** (Police Week into EMS Week). A thank-you to the Chicago Fire Department, Chicago Police and EMTs: fire-truck and ambulance visits, hands-only CPR and water-safety lessons before beach season, and a youth DJ set for first responders and their families. **Partners invited**
Sat, May 22, 1–3 pm	**Spring workshop 6: Dress rehearsal on the beach.** Sound check and a full run-through on the Rainbow Wednesdays spot.
By Fri, May 28	**June lineups announced.** The selection panel (a featured DJ, a neighbor and a music educator) picks the Youth Showcase performers.

a DJ classes

WHEN	WHAT	WHERE
January – May	Winter–spring cohort: 14 weekly 90-minute sessions. Little DJs (5–7, with a grown-up), Junior, Teen, Empress Decks (girls, taught by women DJs) and Grown-Up & Elder DJs. Rainbow Wednesdays prep workshops in April and May.	Fieldhouse room; day and room set with park staff
June – September	Students play Open Decks and the Youth Showcase at Rainbow Wednesdays.	The beach
October – December	Fall cohort: 14 weekly 90-minute sessions; students DJ the holiday parties.	Fieldhouse room

b Rainbow Wednesdays · 6:00–8:30 pm on the beach

DATE	COLOR	THEME
Jun 2	Red	Opening Night: Rainbow Rising **7 pm start**
Jun 9	Orange	Chicago House
Jun 16	Yellow	Freedom Sounds: Juneteenth Week
Jun 23	Green	Riddim & Steel (Caribbean-American Heritage Month)
Jun 30	Blue	Footwork & Juke
Jul 7	Indigo	Old School / New School **7 pm start**
Jul 14	Violet	Afrobeats & Amapiano
Jul 21	Red	Roots & Culture: SelassieFest Warm-Up
Jul 28	Orange	Soul & R&B Sing-Along
Aug 4	Yellow	Gospel at Sunset **7 pm start**
Aug 11	Green	Back-to-School Youth Takeover
Aug 18	Blue	Band Meets Booth
Aug 25	Indigo	Theme Clash Semifinals
Sep 1	Violet + full spectrum	Season Finale: The Rainbow Crown **7 pm start**

Setup from 5:00 pm, cleared by 9:00 pm. On the first Wednesday of each month the music starts at 7:00 pm.

c Live stage shows

June – September	Selected evenings where class graduates and young performers open for local and major artists. Dates are set with park staff, each with its own permit. A girl opens every show.

d Festival and heritage days (proposed)

DATE	DAY
Sat, Jun 19	Juneteenth
Thu, Jul 1	International Reggae Day
Sat, Jul 24	SelassieFest 2027 (venue to be confirmed); the Jul 21 Rainbow Wednesday is its warm-up
Sun, Aug 1	Belize Day (first Sunday in August)
Fri, Aug 6	Jamaica 65: Jamaican Independence

DATE	DAY
Tue, Aug 17 (approx.)	Marcus Garvey Festival
Tue, Aug 31	Trinidad & Tobago Independence
September, date TBD	End-of-summer Full Spectrum festival
Summer, date TBD	SelassieFest community day at Rainbow Beach

e Fall and holiday parties

WHEN	PARTY
Late October	Kids Kostume Party
Early November	Icons Party
Week before Thanksgiving	Thanks & Giving Party
Early December	Holiday Steppers' Set
Mid-December	Christmas Party & Grand Market
Between Dec 26 and 31	Kwanzaa Kuumba Night
Fri, Dec 31, midday	Noon Year's Eve: a family countdown to noon, with kid DJs

Each part starts when it is funded and scheduled with park staff. The season ends with a written report to the park: attendance, performers, girls' participation and audience reach.